

Mailbox math: how many inboxes you actually need

Sizing sending infrastructure is arithmetic, not guesswork. Two rules plus your monthly volume target give you the exact mailbox and domain count.

The two rules

15 cold emails per mailbox per day

Rising to 20 once the mailbox is fully warmed, after about two weeks. This is the house standard, and the honest ceiling.

3 mailboxes per domain

Spread wider than that and you lean on the domain's reputation more than any single mailbox can protect.

Why 15 and not 50. Every batch collects the occasional spam mark. At 15 a day the ratio reads as normal variance. Push 25 or more and the same few marks flag the whole mailbox, then the domain underneath it. Platforms promising a safe 50 a day are selling a bigger number, not a better reply rate.

The formula

01 Monthly volume divided by 22 sending days = daily volume

Most senders skip weekends, so a month is about 22 sending days, not 30. Divide by sending days or you will under-buy.

02 Daily volume divided by 15 = mailboxes needed

Use 15, the day-one safe rate, not the warmed ceiling of 20.

03 Mailboxes divided by 3 = domains needed

That count is the floor. Fewer and you are either over 15 a day per mailbox or under your volume target.

Worked examples

Monthly target	Daily	Mailboxes	Domains	Plan fit
5,000	227	16	6	Essential, \$99 (75,000 emails/mo)
20,000	909	61	21	Essential, \$99
50,000	2,273	152	51	Essential, but nearing its 75,000/mo cap
500,000	22,727	1,515	505	Pro, \$499 (500,000 emails/mo, 10,000 mailbox cap)

The cap your plan sets

Every plan caps mailboxes at 2% of that plan's monthly email volume: 1,500 mailboxes on Essential, 10,000 on Pro. Your math has to clear the cap, not just cover the sending target. If the numbers land above your plan, the plan changes, not the arithmetic.

WHY THIS WORKS ON SENDKIT

Your account runs on its own isolated, dedicated sending infrastructure, so scaling from 16 mailboxes to 1,515 never means sharing reputation with other customers. The math works the same at 5,000 or 5,000,000 emails a month.

Compute yours with the live calculator

Enter your monthly target at sendkit.ai/tools/mailbox-calculator and get your mailbox count, domain count, and plan fit in one pass.

Open the mailbox calculator